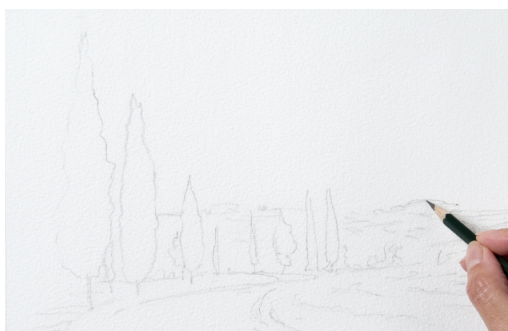


1 Tuscan landscape

At first sight, landscapes look both colorful and rather complex, especially if they are made up of many different shades of green. In this painting, however, orange and blue—complementary colors—are used not only to create a dramatic and vibrant composition, but are also mixed together to make a harmonious range of neutral greens and grays. The sky makes up two thirds of the painting and a basic flat wash is used to great effect to capture the appearance of a deep blue sky on a still, hot summer's day.

PREPARATION



Lightly sketch the outlines of the composition with a soft (4B) pencil, to act as a guide for your painting.



Stick masking tape around the edges of the picture area. This will define the edges of the painting and will help to keep them clean.



1 Use the hake brush to wet the paper in horizontal lines, starting at the top of the picture area and working down to the horizon line. Mop up any excess water with a clean paper towel.



2 Mix a generous amount of cobalt blue on your palette, enough for a wash. When the wet paper has lost its sheen, load the 1 in (25 mm) flat brush with cobalt blue and apply a flat wash of color for the sky.

EQUIPMENT

- Cold-pressed paper
- Masking tape
- 4B pencil
- Brushes: No. 14, 1 in (25 mm) flat, hake, squirrel
- Kitchen towel
- Cobalt blue, cadmium orange, French ultramarine, cadmium red, burnt sienna

TECHNIQUES

- Flat wash
- Graded wash

BUILDING THE IMAGE

